



RCCG OCEANIA

Evangelism & Mission

JESUS THE WORD AND OUR MISSION

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Before anything was made, the Word already was—and all creation came through Him. God raised up a witness to point people to the light, and Jesus Himself came to do the Father's will even when that path involved rejection and humiliation. After His victory, Jesus declares all authority and commissions His followers to go, make disciples, baptize, and teach with confidence in His continual presence.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

John 1:1-3

Matthew 28:18-20

Hebrews 10:7

John 1:6

Mark 15:16

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Jesus is the eternal Word, and all things were made through Him (John 1:1-3).

God appoints witnesses to point people to the light; our role includes faithful testimony (John 1:6).

Jesus came to do God's will, showing obedience as the pattern for true discipleship (Hebrews 10:7).

Following God's will may include suffering and shame, as seen in Jesus' humiliation (Mark 15:16).

The Great Commission flows from Jesus' total authority and His promise to be with His people as they go (Matthew 28:18-20).

INTRODUCTION

Mission begins with identity. If Jesus is the eternal Word and the source of creation, then discipleship is not built on human enthusiasm, personal preference, or cultural pressure. God sends witnesses to point others to the light, and Jesus shows what obedience looks like when it includes rejection and humiliation. From that foundation, the risen Jesus commissions His followers to make disciples of all nations, acting under His authority and relying on His promised presence.

SCRIPTURE READING

John 1:1-3 — This sets the foundation: Jesus as the Word who exists eternally and is the agent of creation.

John 1:6 — This introduces the theme of witness—God sends people to testify and direct others to the light.

Hebrews 10:7 — This highlights Jesus' mission mindset: coming to do God's will, which shapes how disciples think about obedience.

Mark 15:16 — This shows the cost Jesus endured, helping believers interpret hardship without losing confidence in God's plan.

Matthew 28:18-20 — This provides the mandate: because Jesus has all authority, believers are sent to make disciples, baptize, and teach.

KEY POINTS

1. **BEGIN WITH THE WORD** — Discipleship and mission start with who Jesus is, not with what people can accomplish. John presents Jesus as “the Word” who already existed before creation and through whom all things were made. Because Jesus is the eternal Word and the agent of creation, He is not merely a teacher within creation; He stands above it as Lord. The foundation of faith and mission is therefore worship, trust, and submission to Jesus’ identity. When mission is rooted in Jesus’ identity, confidence grows. The work is not carried by human strength alone; it is anchored in the One through whom everything exists.

- Begin prayer and planning by naming who Jesus is (the eternal Word) and aligning motives to honor Him.
- Evaluate goals for discipleship by asking: “Does this reflect Jesus’ lordship, or human preference?”
- Practice speaking about Jesus in ways that highlight His greatness before discussing personal experiences.
- When discouraged, return to John 1:1-3 to rebuild confidence in Jesus’ supremacy.

Scripture: John 1:1-3

2. **LIVE AS A WITNESS** — God’s work includes appointing witnesses. John 1:6 introduces a person “sent from God” with a clear role: to testify. The emphasis is not on the witness drawing attention to himself, but on pointing others toward the light. Witness involves both words and life. Testimony is faithful when it directs attention to Jesus rather than to personal importance, arguments, or reputation. A witness does not need to control outcomes. The calling is to testify faithfully and consistently, trusting God to use that witness according to His purposes.

- Identify one relational setting where testimony can be clearer and more intentional.
- Practice a simple witness pattern: who Jesus is, what He has done, and why it matters.
- Choose one habit that makes your life point to Jesus more clearly (integrity, forgiveness, humility).
- Resist making witness about self-protection; aim to direct attention to the light.

Scripture: John 1:6

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

3. CHOOSE THE FATHER'S WILL — Hebrews describes Jesus' posture: "I have come to do Your will." This statement captures mission as obedience. Jesus' purpose was not self-directed spirituality, but wholehearted alignment with the Father. Discipleship follows that same pattern. Obedience is not merely avoiding wrongdoing; it is active surrender—choosing God's will when alternatives are easier, more comfortable, or more celebrated. This kind of obedience is anchored in trust: God's will is worthy, even when its path is costly or unclear in the moment.

- Ask in prayer: "What would obedience look like in my next decision?" and act on what is clear.
- Name one area where personal will competes with God's will, and take a concrete step of surrender.
- When facing choices, prioritize faithfulness over convenience or approval.
- Use Hebrews 10:7 as a regular personal commitment statement in prayer.

Scripture: Hebrews 10:7

4. ENDURE THE COST WITH CHRIST — Mark records Jesus being mistreated and humiliated. This shows that the path of obedience can include shame, rejection, and injustice. Jesus endured suffering without abandoning the Father's will. Suffering is not automatic proof of failure. Mark 15:16 places humiliation inside the story of Jesus' faithful mission, and Hebrews 10:7 reminds that Jesus' commitment to God's will did not disappear when the cost increased. This reshapes expectations: hardship can be encountered while walking in obedience. The call is to endure with Christ, not to interpret pain as abandonment by God.

- When facing opposition for doing what is right, refuse quick conclusions that God is absent.
- Bring experiences of shame or rejection to God honestly, asking for endurance rather than escape at any cost.
- Choose one faithful action to continue even under pressure (truth-telling, reconciliation, service).
- Encourage another believer who is suffering by pointing to Jesus' endurance and obedience.

Scripture: Mark 15:16 Hebrews 10:7

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

5. GO UNDER HIS AUTHORITY — Jesus declares that all authority belongs to Him and then commissions His disciples to go, make disciples of all nations, baptize, and teach. Mission is not self-appointed; it flows from Jesus' authority. The commission includes a clear scope ("all nations") and clear practices: making disciples, baptizing, and teaching obedience to Jesus' commands. Discipleship is more than information transfer; it is forming lives that learn and obey. Jesus also promises continual presence. Mission is carried out with confidence—not in personal capability, but in Jesus' authority and His nearness as His people go.

- Make discipleship concrete: help someone learn to obey Jesus, not only learn about Him.
- Look beyond familiar boundaries by praying for and engaging people from different backgrounds.
- Support baptism and teaching as ongoing discipleship practices, not one-time events.
- When fear rises, repeat Jesus' authority and presence from Matthew 28:18-20 as a grounding truth.

Scripture: Matthew 28:18-20

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What does John 1:1-3 state about the Word's existence and role in creation?
- What does John 1:6 emphasize about how a witness is appointed and why?
- What is the central statement of purpose in Hebrews 10:7?
- What kind of treatment is described in Mark 15:16, and what does it reveal about Jesus' path?
- List the key commands in Matthew 28:18-20 and the promise attached to them.

INTERPRETATION

How does starting with Jesus as the eternal Word reshape the foundation for mission and discipleship?

Why is it significant that witnesses are described as “sent from God” rather than self-sent (John 1:6)?

In what ways does “I have come to do Your will” define true discipleship (Hebrews 10:7)?

How do Mark 15:16 and Hebrews 10:7 together help interpret suffering without concluding that God’s will has failed?

How does Jesus’ “all authority” in Matthew 28:18 connect to the confidence needed to obey the commission?

APPLICATION

- What is one practical way to keep Jesus’ identity (John 1:1-3) central in your daily decisions this week?
- Where do you sense God calling you to be a clearer witness (John 1:6), and what specific step will you take?
- What decision right now requires choosing the Father’s will over your own (Hebrews 10:7)?
- How can you endure a current hardship in a way that stays aligned with Christ’s obedience (Mark 15:16; Hebrews 10:7)?
- Who is one person you can help move toward discipleship through teaching and encouragement (Matthew 28:18-20), and how will you begin?

PRAYER FOCUS

Exalt Jesus as the eternal Word and align our motives and plans under His lordship.

Make us faithful witnesses who point others to the light with both words and lives.

Strengthen our obedience to the Father’s will, especially when it is costly or misunderstood.

Send us to make disciples, baptize, and teach with confidence in Christ’s authority and continual presence.

NEXT STEP

Identify one person to intentionally disciple and take one concrete step to witness, teach obedience to Jesus, and invite them toward baptism and life in Christ.

CONCLUSION

Jesus is the eternal Word, the foundation of all reality and the beginning of all mission. God sends witnesses to point others to the light, and Jesus models wholehearted obedience to the Father's will—even through humiliation. With all authority, Jesus commissions His disciples to make disciples of all nations, baptizing and teaching with the steady confidence of His continual presence.